

FOREWORD



"Do not be anxious," Jesus said several times in Matthew 6:19–34. The context shows He was talking about money.

Our Lord was not advocating a careless attitude toward our finances. Rather, He was calling us to a level of faith and behavior that is free from money worries.

Married couples in particular would do well to heed His counsel. Statistics show that money trouble is the number-one cause of stress and failure in marriages. Christians are not exempt, and one reason appears to be that many Christian couples are oblivious to what the Bible teaches about managing family finances.

Larry Burkett offers an invaluable remedy for this dilemma. *The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples* is filled with wise and biblical instruction for those who want to know what God's Word says about managing money. Burkett's common-sense approach is neither pedagogical or theoretical, but lively and practical. In simple, straightforward terms, he unfolds an array of scriptural precepts that will help any Christian couple manage their money more effectively and without anxiety.

Years of experience in teaching and counseling Christian families about finances has uniquely prepared Larry Burkett to write this book. He has witnessed the pitfalls. He has seen countless couples struggle with the same issues. He knows the hazards, and he understands the biblical answers. Best of all, he does a masterful job of making them understandable for others.

And these are principles we had better understand. All of us who are believers face judgment one day regarding what kind of stewards we have been. What too many Christians don't realize is that stewardship involves far more than the money we put in the collection plate. It encompasses every element of how we manage the resources God has blessed us with. Perhaps the most telling testing ground of stewardship is the realm of home finances.